THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN AUTHENTIC RENEWAL AND NEW MOVEMENTS OF MISSION—HOPE FOR THE TWENTY-FIRST CENTURY

THE ROLE OF AWAKENINGS AND THE ADVANCE OF THE CHRISTIAN MOVEMENT IN WORLD EVANGELIZATION

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INDEX

INDEX 3

Introduction 4

A Reason for Hope 5
The Problem Defined 7
The Purpose of this Paper 7
Methodological Approach 9

I. A Theoretical Framework 10

II. The Biblical and Theological Basis 18

The Biblical Basis from Pentecost 18
The Theological Basis 20

III. The Historical Evidence to 1950 22

Theorizing on the Major Advances of the Christian Movement 22
An Assessment of the Division of History by Latourette 24
An Assessment of the Epochs of History by Bosch 25
A Proposal for Epochs Based on the Renewal-Mission Connection 28
I. The Great Beginning—0 to 500 A.D. 30
II. The Great Recession—500 to 950 A.D. 31
III. The Great Resurgence with Great Corruption —950 to 1500 A.D. 31
IV. The Great Reformation and the Great Schism— 500 to 1800 A.D. 32
V. The Great Century—1800 to 1900 A.D. 34
VI. The Great Vigor in the Great Storm —1900 to 1950 A.D. 36
The Three Major Pulsations from Pentecost to 1950 37

IV. The Contemporary Evidence 39

The Peoples of the Earth 40
The Charismatic/Post-Denominational/Apostolic Reformation Churches Wave 44
Revivalism and Mission as Social Reform 48
The Two-Thirds World Church Emerges as a Full Partner in Mission 53

V. The Practical Implications 55

Conclusion 58

REFERENCES CITED 60

INTRODUCTION

The creative ongoing activity of the Holy Spirit since Pentecost provides hope for the world of the twenty-first century. The rise of the flood waters of modernity carry along with them the debris of social systems once embedded, decision-making authority traditions and the separation of time and space from their comfortable moorings. In reflecting on the condition of postmodernity, David Harvey argues that there has already been a rite of passage from modernity to postmodernity in contemporary culture. He suggests that what was the flood of modernity has now become a sea-change called postmodernity. "There has been a sea-change in cultural as well as in political-economic practices since around 1982. This sea-change is bound up with the mergence of new dominant ways in which we experience space and time" (1990:vii).

In this paper I invite you to look rather for the underground streams of Holy Spirit activity—often flowing alongside of the structured churches—and you will discover spiritual life, strong families, purposeful mission and social transformation that infuses hope for the future.

A Reason for Hope

We live in a complex world undergoing massive change through globalization and the rapid transition from modernity to postmodernity at the outset of the twenty-first century. One reason for hope lies in the ongoing stream of the Holy Spirit at work through God's people in cities and cultures in the world. If those of God's people who have and are involved in movements of renewal worldwide were to grasp the significance of the inherent linkage between the work of the Spirit in renewal and new initiatives of mission there could be an unprecedented multi-lateral global advance of God's mission in the new century.

To the degree that this missional paradigm of *renewal to mission* is discerned to that extent, the realization of the need to cooperate with the Holy Spirit by stepping out boldly by faith to engage in mission in their cultures and beyond can be enhanced. The potential, should there be a collective "aha" of God's people in renewal worldwide, is for a global wave of Christian advance as the whole church takes the whole gospel to the whole world.

In the last quarter century of the millennium evidences of a genuine work of the Spirit of God have been discerned in many parts of the world, especially in Africa, Asia

and Latin America and among many ethnic peoples in which the gospel entered for the very first time. We are living in the most significant movement of mission in the church. Never have so many people from so many cultures gone to so many different contexts. (Pierson) Another way of saying it is as Ralph Winter did in his paper for the World Mission Conference, held October 1999 in Kyoto, Japan, on "The Role of Western Missions in the 21st century: "The long standing and indeed illustrious campaign to take Western Christianity to the world's minority groups is slowing down because fewer and fewer such groups remain untouched. … the fact is we are running out of 'traditional mission fields.' There aren't many left." The reason for not having many traditional fields, which he goes on to elaborate is because of the amazing advance of the gospel through fresh waves of Christian movement crossing barriers into the minority linguistic and cultural groups over the past decade.

Imagine the global advance in mission that could take place at the beginning of the twenty-first century as God's people become fully aware of their strategic placement for major mission advance as a result of the recent expansion with renewal of the Christian movement. From renewal to mission breaks the bondage of the tide of globalization sweeping across our postmodern world.

The Problem Defined

However, the cause/effect relationship between renewal and mission has yet to be definitively established. Shenk observes: "What is not well established is the inherent linkage between mission and renewal" (1997:154). While suggestions have been made by church historians and scholars of the implicit connection between authentic spiritual revival and authentic mission initiative an explicit development of that vital linkage has yet to be made in the view of Shenk and others. This paper seeks to perpetrate the theory that renewal and new mission are inextricable linked.

The Purpose of this Paper

The purpose of this paper is to make and defend the proposition that authentic renewal leads to new mission and results in the advance of the Christian movement across cultural, social, racial and geographic barriers. A primary result of renewal is increased mission. My thesis is that the renewal of the Church and its expansion are interlinked. New mission movements often come out of movements of renewal. Mission is a normative product of spiritual renewal. Renewal leads to mission and every major new impulse in mission has, by way of precedence, a move of the Holy Spirit. Movements of revival become catalysts for other movements.

> As Edwards indicates in his *History of Redemption*, God's kingdom is like an expanding circle of light in the world's darkness, alternately

> drawing inward in periods of decline and pulsing outward in an increasing circumference. Each of the successfully larger outward pulses is accompanied by a new outpouring of the Holy Spirit (1979:69).

Some Church historians have observed the link between renewal and mission in the expansion of the Christian movement across the ages. "The renewal of the church and its expansion are interlinked. Sometimes there appear to be logical causes underlying a fresh outburst of vitality. But many times it is inexplicable—except to say that God works in the heart of some key individual through whose influence renewal springs forth" (Pierson 2001). Renewal is the work of God resulting in a fresh outburst of Christian movements and new vitality and expansion in the Church. "Authentic renewal will combine a return to the theological roots of the church in Scripture with missionary engagement of its culture" (Shenk 1997:154).

The surges of the Christian movement at and since Pentecost have been directly associated with times of spiritual refreshing and awakening in the Church. Conversely the long gaps in the advance of the Christian movement can be traced to spiritually stagnant periods. Periods of stagnation and decline of the Christian movement, as in the West in our day, become alarming not so much because of declining membership and sagging contributions but rather as Shenk observes: "Genuine renewal is concerned with something more fundamental: Renewal becomes a priority concern when the church has ceased to engage its culture missionally so that its presence in society no longer incites

people into a reconciled relationship with God or witnesses against injustice and unrighteousness" (1997:154).

Methodological Approach

The methodological approach to establishing the important, necessary, explicit and inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and expanding missionary engagement in the local and global culture of our days will include the following:

Review the basic theses of the course on the History and theology of evangelical awakening taught by Dr. Paul E. Pierson at the School of World Mission in the Spring of 2001.

- Survey the literature covering the basic dynamics of spiritual renewal with special emphasis on authors who have studied renewal in depth, such as Jonathon Edwards, considered the greatest theologian of revival, Richard Lovelace, Martin Lloyd Jones, John David Tanner and J. Edwin Orr who traveled the world, researched and wrote more on the topic of revival than anyone.
- Seek new insights by comparing recent findings.
- Draw from personal experiences and reports among various peoples around the world during the decade of the 1990's in the AD2000 & Beyond Movement process, to tell the story from the past twenty-five years.

In building the case that authentic spiritual renewal leads to mission I will seek 1) to develop a theoretical framework, 2) to establish a biblical and theological basis from Pentecost in Acts chapter two, 3) to establish an historical basis from Pentecost to 1950:

4) to establish a contemporary basis by focusing on what happened in the last quarter-century, 5) to suggest some practical implications emerging from the study.

Because of the similarity of meaning, the terms renewal, revival, awakening, and evangelical awakening are used interchangeably in this paper. The definition of evangelicalism can be described in terms of its theological origins:

> Its theological origins begin with the Protestant Reformation of the sixteenth century, but its spiritual lineage traces back even further into the mystical and ascetic countercultures of the medieval and early church through Bernard, Anselm, Augustine, Athanasius and Irenaeus. Since the Reformation it has enjoyed periodic seasons of growth and influence within Protestantism, striving to conserve and propagate the theology of grace … (Lovelace 1979:27).

I. A THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK

Authentic renewal of the Church and its expansion are interlinked. Genuine spiritual renewal looks beyond self to God and His purposes and calls for mission to the world. Renewal is too often defined as an experience. Out of a renewal experience the Church should hear the call of God asking: "Whom shall I send? And who will go for us?" like Isaiah did and spontaneously respond: "Here am I. Send me (Isa. 6:8) !" Isaiah 6 depicts the classic order of renewal movements. As men and woman go deeper in their

life with God they realize who they are and the voice of God sending them out into the world.

Lovelace seeks to identify the main streams of spiritual vitality which have flowed through the church's history to determine the principles which govern renewal (1979:11-12). He follows the Pietists and Edwards closely in his book on the dynamics of spiritual life, in which he emphasizes the importance that interior spiritual development rightfully leads to responsible engagement with society and culture (1979:17). He describes the exterior spiritual development elements and responsible engagement with society and culture elements as second, which I take to refer to the sequential causative result of renewal (Figure 1). In his reflection on the interior spiritual development elements in the history of church renewal, Lovelace inextricably links the essential elements of renewal with the realization of a believer's union with Christ. "Spiritual life flows out of union with Christ…" (1979:74). He asserts that the primary elements of renewal flow directly out of our union with Christ.

> There are two… results of our union with Christ in his death and resurrection, which stand to immediately as critically important elements in the history of the church renewal: *justification and sanctification*. We have seen that most of the major awakenings have involved among their central catalysts a balanced proclamation of justification by faith and the necessity of progressive sanctification (1979:74).

As a result of our union with Christ, in addition to the benefits of 1) justification: you are accepted and 2) sanctification: you are free from the bondage of sin, Lovelace

adds two more primary elements of renewal, 3) the indwelling Spirit; you are not alone and 4) authority in spiritual conflict; you have authority. Beyond the primary elements of renewal Lovelace identifies and develops the secondary elements of renewal as well as preconditions for renewal as in the following figure (1979:75).

Lovelace relates renewal to mission as the fifth element following justification, sanctification, the indwelling Spirit and authority in spiritual conflict. He distinguishes the first elements of renewal as depth presentation of the Gospel and the secondary elements of renewal as the outworking of the Gospel in the Church's life. In relegating mission to a category called "secondary" elements of renewal, he risks being misunderstood in suggesting that the former is more important than the latter. In my view he is making the point that renewal needs to happen within before it can happen

FIGURE 1

BIBLICAL MODELS OF CYCLICAL AND CONTINUOUS RENEWAL (LOVELACE 1979:75)

I. Preconditions of Renewal: Preparation for the Gospel

A. Awareness of the holiness of God
- his justice
- his love

B. Awareness of the depth of sin
- in your own life
- in your own community

II. Primary Elements of Renewal: Depth Presentation of the Gospel

A Justification: You are accepted—in Christ

B. Sanctification: You are free from bondage to sin—in Christ

C. The Indwelling Spirit: You are not alone—in Christ

D. Authority in Spiritual Conflict: You have authority—in Christ

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III. Secondary Elements of Renewal: Outworking of the Gospel in the Church's life

A. Mission: following Christ into the world presenting the gospel
—in proclamation
— in social demonstration

B. Prayer: expressing dependence on the power of his Spirit
—individually
—corporately

C. Community: being in union with his body
—in microcommunities
—in macrocommunities

D. Disenculturation: being freed from cultural binds—destructive and protective

E. Theological integration: having the mind of Christ—toward revealed truth
—toward your culture

without as a natural outworking. Thus he emphasizes the sequence and not the significance of the dynamics of renewal in his categorization of the elements or characteristics of renewal.

Ron Davies correctly links revival and mission in his definition:

> A revival is a sovereign outpouring of the Holy Spirit on a group of Christians resulting in their spiritual reviving and quickening, and issuing in the awakening of special concern in formal church members. An immediate or at times a long term effect will be efforts to extend the influence of the Kingdom of God, both **intensively** in the society in which the church is placed, and **extensively** in the spread of the gospel to more remote parts of the world (Pierson 2001).

John David Tanner affirms the inherent linkage between renewal and mission to the world in his summary of the primary characteristics of revival (1994).

- Phenomena of the Day of Pentecost
- Results of outpouring of the Holy Spirit, new life produced.
- Focus on the Church, brings the Church back to life.
- Christians discover new dimensions of reality in their walk with God.
- As the church experiences new life, it has great impact on the world through prayer, preaching, and witnessing.
- A revived church has social impact, society is transformed, the helpless and oppressed are liberated. There are visible works of mercy.

  The church is empowered to reach across the world.

"Jonathan Edwards' criteria on renewal remains the classical treatment and are still the best for identifying genuine movement of renewal" (Packer 1990:37). According to Edwards an authentic spiritual awakening does the following:

- Exalts Jesus Christ.
- Attacks the kingdom of darkness.
- Honors the Scriptures.
- Promotes sound doctrine.
- Results in an outpouring of love to God and persons expressed in practical ways (Houston 1984:xviii).

With regard to his distinguishing mark "attacks the kingdom of darkness," Lovelace elaborates: "There is another agency battling the light, and spiritual warfare is part of the ebb and flow of the church's experience" (1979, 69).

These distinguishing marks of revival can be summarized in a table showing the dynamics between spiritual renewal and the affective and cognitive human capacities resulting in missional action which was obtained from a class handout titled: "Distinguishing Marks of a Campus Revival" (Pierson 2001).

FIGURE 2

JONATHAN EDWARD'S DISTINGUISHING MARKS AND THE DYNAMICS OF SPIRITUAL RENEWAL AND RESULTING ACTION

Revival/Renewal	**Affective** **Feelings/Emotions**	**Cognitive** **Knowledge**	**Behavior** **Action**
Testifies to deeper love for God	Experiences God's presence more strongly	Understand more about God	Fellowship more with God
Testifies to exaltation of Christ	Experiences a deeper love for Jesus	Understand more about Jesus	Exalt Christ in worship and life
Evidences more love for others	Feel a deeper love for brothers and sisters in Christ	Decide to build more Christian relationships	Work on building relationships with others
Evidences more love for the Bible / truth	Experiences a deeper love for the truth of the Bible.	Decide to study the Bible more	Spend more time in the Bible and walking in the truth
Evidences less love for the world	Feel less desire for worldly pleasure	Decide to stop activities that do not honor Jesus Christ	Reaches out in compassionate mission

In the course on the history and theology of evangelical awakening which he inherited from J. Edwin Orr after his premature death, Pierson presents several theses on renewal not sequenced in any particular order as follows:

1. Every revival or awakening involves certain generic factors; e.g. fervent prayer, a new experience of the holiness and transcendence of God, of our sin, and grace.
2. Such movements also include elements specific to the context; e.g. unity in the Moravian movement, reconciliation in the Korean and E African revivals.
3. They lead the Church, or at least that part of the Church involved in the movement, to reach out beyond its normal constituency, to the poor, marginalized, etc.
4. They involve some degree of recontextualization, that is, often in terms of the aspects of the Gospel, which are communicated, who communicates, to whom, where, and how, the message is communicated.
5. They seem always to arise on the periphery of the larger ecclesiastical structure, that is, the institutional church, with men or women of little status in leadership. Some may be ordained, some unordained.
6. They may involve unusual manifestations in some cases, or they may not.
7. They are countercultural to some degree but often lose this aspect as time goes by and they conform more and more to the surrounding culture.
8. They bring opposition from some in the Church and fanaticism by some in the movement.
9. They lead to greater social concern and social transformation at the personal level, in ministries to the poor, etc, and at times to structural social changes.
10. They lead to mission beyond their own social, cultural, and geographical contexts.
11. Distance decreases; between God and humans, (paradox of the transcendent and holy God who come near), between men and women, races, social classes, denominations, etc. Greater unity a result.
12. A return to the study of Scripture.
13. A heightened sense of spiritual warfare.
14. Renewed emphasis on the Holy Spirit.
15. Often the context is one of crisis, political, economic, social.
16. The need for flexibility of structures if the movement is not to be crushed.
17. Finally, every movement is messy, less than perfect (2001).

For the purpose of this paper the tenth thesis is the primary matter under scrutiny. Renewal leads to mission beyond the Church's own social, cultural, and geographical context. This is the proposition I am seeking to prove. One of the primary arguments for the renewal/mission connection is the biblical basis.

II. THE BIBLICAL AND THEOLOGICAL BASIS

The Biblical Basis from Pentecost

Orr, Lovelace, Martin Lloyd Jones and Tanner agree that the events which occurred on the Day of Pentecost were typical of the characteristics of revival (1979:49)

"Revival is an outpouring of the Spirit of God. It is a kind of repetition of Pentecost. It is the Spirit descending on the people. This needs to be emphasized. We have been told that everyone at regeneration receives the baptism of the Spirit. All he has to do is surrender to what he already has. But revival does not come as a result of surrendering to what he already has. It is the Spirit being poured out on him, descending on him, as happened on the day of Pentecost" (Pierson 2001).

According to Orr, the major marks of an evangelical awakening are always some repetition of the phenomena of the Acts of the Apostles (Pierson 2001). He lists the

following eight components in the Day of Pentecost which may be traced through many subsequent revivals.

1. The blessing was predicted and soon fulfilled (Acts 1:8)
2. Extraordinary praying (Upper room)
3. People were filled with the Spirit.
4. Preaching with power, accompanied by prophesying, dreams and visions.
5. Mighty conviction when people were "drummed to the earth."
6. Public confession of faith (in baptism)
7. Apostolic teaching, fellowship, communion, a prayer.
8. No hostile power was able to hinder them. (Pierson 2001)

Orr defines revival as "An evangelical awakening is a movement of the Holy Spirit bringing about a revival of New Testament Christians in the church and its related community. The revived church is moved to engage in evangelism, teaching, and social action." He affirms the cause/effect relationship between renewal and mission. However, I would agree with Pierson and differ with Orr's appeal to New Testament Christianity as the normative model for authentic renewal. The church in Corinth was anything but a model of authentic renewal. Regardless, clearly, the revival at Pentecost launched the expansion of the Christian movement into mission engagement in the cultures of its day with abandon and in doing so establishes an important biblical precedent to the inherent linkage between revival and mission.

The Theological Basis

One of the most convincing evidences of the inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and mission is the theological matter of the nature of God, the Holy Spirit. Forty five of the ninety four references to the Holy Spirit in the Bible or almost fifty percent are made in the book of Acts alone. Pentecost and the book of Acts are viewed by the cited scholars of revival as the primary standard for measuring authentic revival. The Holy Spirit is sent by the Father and the Son to awaken, renew and revive the church (Acts 1:2, 5, 8, 16, 2:4, 33, 38; 4: 8, 25, 31, 5:3, 32, 6:5, 7:51, 55, 8:15, 16, 17, 19, 9:17, 31, 10:38, 44, 45, 47, 11:15, 16, 24, 13:2, 4, 9, 52, 15:8, 28, 16:2, 19:2, 6, 20:23, 28, 21:11, 28:25).

On the other hand the Holy Spirit provides supernatural empowerment for the purpose of mission. As in Acts 1:8, "But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth." "The Holy Spirit, sent by both the Father and the Son, empowers the disciples to proclaim the message by both word and deed (Mark 16:20) and accompanies the church as she discharges her missionary calling. And when the church refuses to heed Christ's command and neglects his orders, it is the work of the Spirit which for a time is thus being frustrated and sabotaged" (Verkuyl 1978:112). Thus the activity of the Holy Spirit as seen in the book of Acts revives the church to reach the

world through word and deed. This establishes the theological consistency of the thesis that an inherent linkage exists between renewal and mission because it is the same Holy Spirit that activates a spirit of renewal and mission and provides the linkage between the two as observed in the book of Acts.

Beyond the action of the Holy Spirit the fact that renewal leads to mission occurs because of the very nature of the Holy Spirit. “The general doctrine of the Scriptures on this subject is that the Spirit is the executive of the Godhead. Whatever God does, He does by the Spirit (Hodge 1997). As God is committed to mission so the Holy Spirit is committed to mission on the basis of the very essence of his being. “The Holy Spirit the primary agent of mission, and human beings are secondary” (Glasser, Van Engen, Gililland 2001:389). Since the Holy Spirit serves as the executive of the triune God, He cannot fail in his mission and since the Holy Spirit by his very nature is the primary agent of mission rather than the human being, believers in God should yield themselves to God’s purposes as his human instruments of mission.

Jonathon Edwards and the Puritans understanding about revival is considered by scholars, such as J.I Packer and church historians such as Paul Pierson, as the classic and the best treatment. One reason may have been their realization of the role of the Holy Spirit. “Further light on the Puritan revival would come from a study of Puritan theology, in particular its unprecedented interest in and concentration on the ministry of the Holy

Spirit" (Packer 1990:48). However, it was the Pentecostal movement that emphasized most definitively the role of the Holy Spirit.

> Pentecostalism is distinguished by its emphasis on an immediate and personal experience of the Holy Spirit and the urgency of evangelization. The starting point is not rational discourse about the person and work of the Spirit but direct personal encounter with the Holy Spirit and the release of the charismata of the Spirit in the life of the believer. This emphasis on experience and a desire to see the experiences of the first Christians reproduced today has resulted in vigorous missionary activism among Pentecostals (Shenk 2001).

III. THE HISTORICAL EVIDENCE TO 1950

In this section the historical evidence from Pentecost to 1950 will be reviewed to demonstrate the inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and expanding missionary engagement

Theorizing on the Major Advances of the Christian Movement

Surges of the Christian movement have been called by different names but conceptualize around the idea of a divinely initiated spiritual impulse that renews God's people to reach the world.

Church historian Latourette calls significant advances "pulsations". He writes of "Resurgences" of Christianity, while the periods of stagnation and decline he refers to as "Recessions." He repeatedly uses the term "recrudescence" in describing a renewed vitality in the Christian movement. Pulses involve mission expansion initiatives out of a context of struggle eventually gaining acceptance in flourishing period which scholars call a renaissance. Resurgences of Christianity often are followed by recessions.

> The pattern of expansion, he suggested, had been like seven successive waves of an incoming tide. The crest of each wave was higher than the crest that had preceded it, and the trough of each wave receded less than the one before it. … Each advance has carried it further than the one before it. Of the alternating recessions, each has been briefer and less marked than the one which preceded it (Bosch:1991:334).

Different historians use different criteria for dividing history. It raises the question: "What kind of criteria does a historian use in identifying these eras?"

In each of the major pulsations of the worldwide Christian movement I will seek to demonstrate that there exists a preceding renewal to demonstrate by church history the inherent linkage between renewal and mission. In the process of reading up on the major pulsations of the Christian movement I will be reading up on post-Pentecost movements to seek to theorize about these movements in pursuit of fresh insight and application on the nature of renewal and how it has been mediated in the past toward the expansion of the Christian movement.

An Assessment of the Division of History by Latourette

Latourette uses the criteria for discerning the pulsations in the life of Christianity as "…reflected in its vigour and its influence upon the ongoing history of the race. His threefold criteria for identifying these pulsations are: "—the expansion or recession of territory in which Christians are to be found, the new movements issuing from Christianity, and the effect of Christianity as judged from the perspective of mankind as a whole" (1953, 1975:xxi). For Latourette, the first pulsation embraced roughly the initial five centuries in which "Christianity won the professed allegiance of the large majority of the population of the Roman Empire. The second pulsation lasted from 500 to 950 A.D. in which "Christianity suffered the greatest losses which it has ever encountered. Its very existence was threatened (xxii)." From 950 to 1350 A.D. in Latourette's time-line he considers these to be four centuries of advance (xxiii). These were the years of the Crusades which by no means in my view should be considered advance even based on his own criteria which includes "the effect of Christianity as judged from the perspective of mankind as a whole." Even if the other two criteria of territorial expansion and the issuing of new Christian movements were true in this epoch, the disgrace of the Crusades outweigh the other two in my perspective. The fourth pulsation in Latourette's division of history was one of decline in which much territory was lost and corruption appeared in the churches (xxiii). Then came what he calls an

"amazing epoch" from 1500 to 1750 A.D. in which a series of awakenings revitalized Christianity (xxiii). The sixth pulsation from 1750 and 1815 presented a threat to the established church while ushering in new life in Christianity. Per Latourette, the seventh pulsation from 1815 to 1914 constituted the Great Century in which Christianity spread all over the world" (xxiv). The final chapter of Latourette's historical review of Christianity from 1914 to 1952 he describes as "vigor amidst the storm" (xxiv).

An Assessment of the Epochs of History by Bosch

Bosch adapts the paradigm theory of Thomas Kuhn to church history in the pursuit of a contemporary paradigm for mission (Bosch 1991:181-183). Based on the premise that because each epoch of church history reflects profound dissimilarity, Bosch suggests that we "not appeal in a direct manner to the words of the biblical authors and apply what they said…" but rather that we should engage in creative … "but responsible freedom, prolong the logic of the ministry of Jesus and the early church in an imaginative and creative way to our own time and context" (Bosch 1991:181). He proceeds to reflect on what mission meant in the successive periods up to the present and then "...draw the contours, in broad strokes, of a contemporary paradigm for mission" (181).

Bosch follows the historic-theological subdivisions of history suggested by Hans Kung who based his epochs on "theological" paradigms according to Thomas Kuhn's theory of "paradigm shifts" (Bosch 1991:183). But in that Kuhn himself was charged with using the term in at least twenty-two senses for the purposes of his research. Bosch uses the simplistic concept that a paradigm shift involves a "change from one way of understanding reality to another" (1991:185).

1. The apocalyptic paradigm of primitive Christianity.
2. The Hellenistic paradigm of the patristic period.
3. The medieval Roman Catholic paradigm.
4. The Protestant (Reformation) paradigm.
5. The modern Enlightenment paradigm.
6. The emerging ecumenical paradigm.

In each of these six periods there exists a different understanding of the Christian faith. A missiological paradigm approach to the historical epochs of Christian history add fresh insight into the process of missiological reflection. The process contributes to the reflection required in consideration of a contemporary paradigm of mission. Through the journey of the six epochs of similar and yet distinct missiological paradigms, the reader enters into the historical contextual challenges and opportunities for God's people on a mission. It helps to understand why the Church did what it did at certain periods of church history.

On the other hand, the approach does not adequately support the progressive nature of building a missiological consciousness based on the experiences of the mission initiatives from previous epochs. As acknowledged in the paradigm theory it "… fosters relativism, that there really are no ultimate norms or values" (Bosch186). The missiological paradigmic approach softens the imperatives and absolutes of commissioning as received at one historical moment by the Lord Jesus Christ. It becomes a matter of hermeneutical debate. "Perhaps the greatest need in current ecumenical debate is to find an agreed biblical hermeneutic, for without this a broader consensus on the meaning and obligation of 'mission' is unlikely ever to be reached" (Stott 1975:10).

However, my biggest critique of the "the Bosch approach" is the viewing church history for the most part with the lens of man's world view. It is the Hellenistic period, the medieval paradigm, the modern enlightenment paradigm. Thus, his view rests on men's historical secular initiative rather than God's meta initiative. I would suggest that a more appropriate way of viewing history would be to see it in terms of God's initiative of spiritual renewal of his people leading to new initiatives of mission by his people. It involves both God and man as the mission agency. Perhaps the most exhaustive survey of Christian history was written by Phillip Schaff who introduced his work with the helpful consideration on the nature of history.

> History has two sides, a divine and a human. On the part of God, it is his revelation in the order of time (as the creation is his revelation in the

> order of space), and the successive unfolding of a plan of infinite wisdom, justice, and mercy, looking to his glory and the eternal happiness of mankind. On the part of man, history is the biography of the human race, and the gradual development, both normal and abnormal, of all its physical, intellectual, and moral forces to the final consummation at the general judgment, with its eternal rewards and punishments. The idea of universal history presupposes the Christian idea of the unity of God, and the unity and common destiny of men, and was unknown to ancient Greece and Rome. A view of history which overlooks or undervalues the divine factor starts from deism and consistently runs into atheism; while the opposite view, which overlooks the free agency of man and his moral responsibility and guilt, is essentially fatalistic and pantheistic (Schaff 1997).

A Proposal for Epochs Based on the Renewal-Mission Connection

My time-line chart of the development of the Christian movement draws both from Pierson and Latourette. It is based on the identifiable surges and resulting epochs of the Christian movement associated with spiritual awakenings as summarized in the following figure.

TABLE 3

A PERSPECTIVE ON THE HISTORICAL DEVELOPMENT OF THE CHRISTIAN MOVEMENT

EPOCHS	HISTORICAL CONTEXT	WORLD EVENTS	CHRISITAN MOVEMENT	PERSPECTIVE
I. 0 to 500 A.D. Birth pangs—growth	The Roman Empire	70 AD Jerusalem destroyed 10 Persecut's	Early Church Monasticism Celtic	The Great Beginning
II. 500 to 950 Decline	Barbarian rule Feudalism Muslim conquest	Vikings	Nestorian Cluny Waldensian Lollards	The Great Recession
III. 950 to 1500 Decline	Emerging middle class Nation states Renaissance	Crusades Inquisition	Protestant Catholic Radical Reformations	Ruthless resurgence, territorial advance, abuse, corruption
IV. 1500 to 1800 Rebirth and resurgence	Colonialism Rationalism	1517 95 Theses Modern democracy	Puritanism Pietism Moravianism Methodism	The Great Reformation, Schism, and Expansion
V. 1800 to 1900 Expansion	Technological progress	Education	Modern Missionary Movement	The Great Century
VI. 1914 to 1950 Vigor	World War I and II	1906 Azusa 1910 Edin.	Pentecostal Ecumenical	
VII. 1950-	Acc. Change Globalization	Lausanne 74 GCOWE 95	2/3rds world	Non-western church initiative

As can be observed in Figure 3 on the historical development of the Christian movement, on various notable occasions there have been surges in the Christian Movement, which I am suggesting are related to movements of spiritual awakening. A drive for a deeper, more authentic Christian life usually on the part of a small group leads to spiritual renewal and a broader concern for changing society. A brief review of the frist six epochs establishes unequivocally the thesis that the renewal of the Church and its expansion are interlinked.

I. The Great Beginning—0 to 500 A.D.

This period involved the Roman world. With the coming of the Holy Spirit at Pentecost the Church was born amidst the birth pangs of both Jewish and Roman opposition. The spiritual renewal in the book of Acts became a standard by which all future renewals would be measured. Jesus brought the gospel to the Jews and the world as light breaking through darkness. Stephen ‘s martyrdom impacted the Jews especially one standing there by the name of Saul. Saul became Paul and took the gospel to the Hellenistic Jews and the Gentiles. Early monastics sought to live consistent to the gospel, seeking personal renewal. Some became missionaries like Anthony who went to Egypt. Patrick demonstrated deep devotion to God with a love of learning and the Scriptures and missionary heart impacted Ireland.

II. The Great Recession—500 to 950 A.D.

This period involved the Barbarian World. The rapid expansion of the church since the time of the early apostles via the Celtic and Nestorian efforts, had largely ceased by the end of the first millennium. These were the darkest years for Christianity. It appeared as if the light of the gospel might be snuffed out. Barbarian rule claimed one-third of the clergy. Muslim conquerors took one-half of the so-called Christian Roman lands in just fifty years. "The morale of Christian communities declined to their lowest ebb" (Latourette, xxii).

III. The Great Resurgence with Great Corruption —950 to 1500 A.D.

This period involved the Viking World. Papal power reaches its pinnacle. For 200 years, Crusaders were called out of the emerging middle class restless youth to participate in seven ruthless and violent crusades, expanding the so-called Christian territories but destroying the testimony of Christian compassion. Papal unquestioning, accompanied by indulgences and corruption led eventually to the papal captivity with three people calling themselves the Pope. On the periphery of the institutional church renewals movements arose, including Cluny bringing reform to monasticism and Olav Tryggvason in Norway.

Out of renewal accompanied by Bible reading and memorizing, the Waldensians were sent off as itinerant missionaries disguised as merchants in the thirteenth and early fourteenth centuries. Banned from the official church as early as 1300 the Lollards experienced renewal as they experienced a renewal in personal salvation, interpreting the Bible through God's illumination and race directly to the *laos,* with every believer gifted and empowered to read the Bible. This led to mission as they went out two by two in mission. Dipping into the spiritual stream from which the Lollards drank, and in the process defending John Wycliffe, was John Huss out of Czech. He refused to recant and bow to the infallibility of a corrupt Pope established at the Council of Constance with the words, "I shall die with joy to-day in the faith of the gospel which I have preached." He was burned at the stake leaving a trail of believers called Hussites (Schaff 1997).

IV. The Great Reformation and the Great Schism— 1500 to 1800 A.D.

This period involved a global territorial advance. "The Reformation of the sixteenth century is, next to the introduction of Christianity, the greatest event in history" (Schaff 1997). The secular TIME-LIFE media consortium ranked the event they titled: *Luther Knocks Down the Door* as the third most significant event of the last millennium. On October 31, 1517, Luther nailed "Ninety-Five Theses" to the door of the All Saints

Church in Wittenberg, Germany, stressing the inward, spiritual character of the Christian faith and denouncing the papal policy of selling of "indulgences." When asked by Vatican to recant he replied: "Here I stand, I can do no other." Political authority would never again be fully subject to the dictates of a distant clergy, and the map of Europe would be determined by the nationalism that still dominates world politics today.

Protestant spiritual reform movements following Luther, Calvin, Zwingli and John Knox advanced the gospel in Northern Europe. The profound spiritual awakening of justification by faith alone launched a culturally engaging mission movement that can be traced to the remotest corners of the globe at the beginning of this twenty-first century.

Meanwhile leading a counter-reformation, Ignatius Loyola and the Popes sought to expand following moral and administrative reform of their institutions and Jesuits such as Xavier and Ricci advanced the Christian movement to India, China and Japan. During this time Roman Catholic missionaries, with the sword in one hand the cross in the other, accompanied Europeans in pursuit of lands and peoples to conquer and plunder and a corrupted Christianity spread to the new world of Latin America.

In the 18th century, out of the seedbed of the renewal movements of Puritanism, Pietism, Moravianism and Methodism launched the modern era of missions. Each of these movements stressed the need for personal conversion, used the Scriptures in personal devotions and cultivated spiritual renewal in small groups giving a greater role

to the laity. The Puritans integrated faith and life improving the quality of the life of the family. “Committed communities” arose from the Pietists who engaged in social need as pioneers in education for the poor and practical assistance for the widows and orphans. The Moravians sought balance of the Spirit and the Word. Renewal led to mission overseas. One of those they shared the gospel with, John Wesley, was soundly converted and launched serious renewal disciplines and mission that not only engaged the culture of the day but ultimately transformed it. Religious freedom, educational institutions and modern democracy were fruits of the four creative, related “renewal to mission” movements.

V. The Great Century—1800 to 1900 A.D.

Christianity extended to the end of the earth. The dawning of the nineteenth century brought an explosion of mission agencies committed to glorify God through evangelism and social work following the lead of William Carey. The first wave of modern missions moved over the coastlines of the continents. Then, in the second half of the 19th century faith missions, as a movement, began with Hudson Taylor, gaining great momentum and peaked in the 1890s. The second wave of modern missions moved into the interiors of the continents.

The Great Awakening took place out of the Puritan spiritual streams in four phases, 1726-56, 1776-1810, 1813-46 and 1857-95 (Cairns 1986:20-21). Whitfield, Wesley and Edwards led the Great Awakening. The Second Awakening erupted in camp meetings and on College campuses in North America. The third phase focused on revivalistic evangelists, mainly Charles Finney and the fourth phase brought global ecumenical and lay prayer revival to the fore with D. L. Moody playing a prime role. The Evangelical Awakenings beginning in 1945 were triggered by revivalist evangelists of which the greatest impact since that time has been exercised through the ministry of Billy Graham.(Cairns 1986:20-21). Often these awakening did not give birth directly to missionary activities but at least laid the foundations for them (Bosch 1991:278).

Toward the end of the century it was Moody who joined with his colleague A.T. Pierson to advocate "finishing the task" by 1900. . "I wish by voice and by the aid of the press to set forth a practicable business proposition, namely, that before the year 1900, the gospel shall be preached to every living soul." By 1885, Moody, Pierson and evangelists, pastors and missionaries penned a joint declaration, "An Appeal to Disciples Everywhere," in which they announced the strategy. "If but ten millions, out of four hundred millions of nominal Christians, would undertake such systematic labors as that each one of that number should, in the course of the next fifteen years, reach one hundred other souls with the gospel message, the whole present population of the globe would have heard the good tidings by the year 1900!" One of the most serious proposals was

offered by J. Hudson Taylor for the country of China who by 1900 had diffused nearly 1000 missionaries throughout china. The Student Volunteer Movement, in the last decade of the 19th century which by 1886 had prompted 10,000 college students to pledge their lives to foreign missions (Johnson 1999).

VI. The Great Vigor in the Great Storm —1900 to 1950 A.D.

Christianity endured in the midst of World War I and II. Under the extensive ministry of John R. Mott, by the end if the first decade of the twentieth century, "world evangelization in this generation" became a central theme and expectation. This rose to a peak in the great Edinburgh Conference of 1910.

Meanwhile at a house on Azusa Street in Los Angeles the poor, the disenfranchised and immigrants met for prayer meetings. On April 9, 1906, several had the experience of tongues and they were forced to move to a stable because of the large crowds. This went on virtually every night for three years led by William Seymour, a one-eyed black holiness preacher. Out of this time of spiritual renewal the Pentecostal Movement exploded with new leadership, including women, empowered by the gifts of the Holy Spirit, embracing literal biblicism and an experiential Christianity with a missionary urgency which in the next century swept throughout the world.

However, much of the drive and optimism of the fifty years leading up to World War I died with the total breakdown of hope in the Western World as a result of the war, shattering the illusion that Western culture was Christian. The ensuing emphasis on the social gospel and theological liberalism focused more on social transformation than evangelism.

The Three Major Pulsations from Pentecost to 1950

The macro spiritual impulses leading to mission advance as established in the criteria of Latourette from Pentecost to 1950 demonstrated the inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and expansion of the Christian movement. Perhaps the greatest symbiotically connected renewal and advance occurred in the first chapter of Christian history from 0 to 500 A.D. Every movement of mission was new. The territorial expansion encompassed the entire Roman world, and Christianity had become the religion of the Empire.

The second macro spiritual impulse in terms of impact occurred when the creative, yet related renewal movements of Puritanism, Pietism, Moravianism and Methodism from 1600 to 1800 became the seed-bed for the modern mission movements from 1800 to 1900. During the eighteenth century the powerful forces of renewal crossed continents and climaxed in a worldwide Evangelical Awakening. The Great Evangelical

Awakening launched a perpetual proliferation of missionary societies throughout the church and the world. The stream of mission flowing from Methodism flowed all the way into the twentieth century in Latin America, into a third macro pulsation of mission in what Martin calls the Methodist/Pentecostal Connection (Martin 1990:28). "What Methodism and Pentecostalism clearly share is an emphasis on the availability of grace to all, a millennial hope, and an intense search after 'scriptural holiness'" (1990:28).

The third macro spiritual impulse of mission took place out of the spiritual and doctrinal renewal at the beginning of the twentieth century that led to the Pentecostal/Charismatic global movement. The number of Pentecostals and Charismatics out of this renewal movement at the beginning of the century grew to 524 million worldwide by mid-2000 (Barrett 2001). "Recent historical and sociological studies have advanced the argument that the Pentecostal movement has contributed not only to the redefinition of religion worldwide but also to constructive change in the wider society" (Shenk 2001). David Martin traces the historical genealogy of Puritanism, Methodism, and Pentecostalism. He shows how these religious movements have contributed to the transformation of culture. "As the sacred canopy in Latin America is rent and the all-encompassing system cracks, evangelical Christianity pours in and by its own autonomous native power creates free social space" (Martin 1990:280).

IV. THE CONTEMPORARY EVIDENCE

The contemporary evidence of a renewal/mission connection is traced from 1950 to 2000. “What are the new forms of renewal/mission that emerged in the last fifty years?” Out of the global crises of the first and the Second World Wars a new spiritual surge in mission took place, with 150 mission agencies formed in just five years, mainly to service existing missions through radio, publications, Bible translation, and air travel. In the midst of the increasing diversity of the issues and movements of church and mission over the last fifty years of the century, spiritual renewal movement advanced as a stream, catalyzed from earlier revivalist movements and expressions, fostering a diversity of expressions in mission and the advance of the gospel, including a massive global prayer movement that crescendoed in the final decade of the millennium. Four significant fresh spiritual surges emerged related to the thesis that renewal leads to mission. These developments include 1) the movement to evangelize the distinct ethnolinguistic and cultural peoples of the earth, 2) the emergence of a two-thirds world force and influence for mission, 3) the pursuit of holistic mission and 4) the reshaping of the church.

The Peoples of the Earth

A third wave of modern missions emerged focused on the "hidden peoples," who had been spiritually by-passed and were yet to be reached with the gospel in the second half of the twentieth century this was on top of the previous ninetieth century waves of missions to the coastlines of the continents and selected missions to the interiors of the continents. In 1917 William Cameron Townsend was trying to sell Spanish Bibles in Guatemala when a Cakchiquel-speaking Indian challenged him, "If your God is so smart, why can't he speak our language?" Recognizing the linguistic barrier to the gospel, he answered that Indian's challenge with a Cakchiquel New Testament in 1931. Not long afterwards, Donald A. McGavran, a missionary in India, observed that mass movements to Christ occurred when churches formed and grew within a specific people group. He observed that "most nations are mosaics of distinct people groups, and the great commission requires disciple-making in each piece of the mosaic—panta ta ethne." With this concept he pioneered the missiological understanding of unreached peoples and launched the Church Growth Movement (McGavran 1955:167). It was at the influential International Congress on World Evangelization in Lausanne, Switzerland in 1974 that Ralph D. Winter argued, since churches normally grow *within* the limits of a given ethnic-language group and that an estimated one-half of the world's population were

locked away from the gospel by cultural barriers, the *highest priority* is *cross-cultural evangelism.* He became an early proponent for the vision of a church for every people by the year 2000 and popularized the concept in the last twenty five years of the century. In the last ten years of the century, the AD2000 and Beyond Movement undertook the mission of a church for every people and the gospel, for every person by the year 2000 brought people together new coalitions and networks to seek to fulfill that vision. Significant process was made in the collection of information, its distribution and mobilization of prayer, networking, specific people partnerships, church adoptions of peoples and documentation of the results. Figure 4 reflects the progress in the last fifty years and the status of a church for every people and figure 5 shows the gospel for every people at the year 2000.

Where did the spiritual initiative come for the final decadal initiative focus in Mathew 28 and Mark 16? Although a global symbiotic coalition of churches and missions came together in 1995 from some 186 countries of the world at GCOWE '95 in Seoul, Korea, the primary thrust came from the two-thirds world churches in renewal, plus the Charismatic independent churches, also called Post-denominational or Apostolic Reformation Churches. The final decadal compilation made by the AD2000 Movement is reflected in Figure 4 and 5 (Scribner 2000:34-35).

Figure 4

A Church for Every People Group

"Go therefore and make disciples of all the nations" Matt 28:19

People Group Criteria	Number of Groups	Rounded Population	Population Percent
Above 10,000 population > 2% Evangelical or > 5% Adherents	6000	3,620 million	60.3%
Above 10,000 population < 2% Evangelical and < 5% Adherents	1600	2,350 million	39.2%
Below 10,000 population	5400	30 million	0.5%
World Totals	13000	6,000 million	100.00%

Key Observation: There are approximately 13,000 total people groups, more than 40% of which are smaller than 10,000 in population

Church Planting Status	Population	Population Percent
Targeted for Church Planting by mid-2002	6,000 million	100.0%
Targeted for Church Planting by Dec 31, 2000	5,925 million	98.8%
Church Planting Team currently on-site	5,889 million	98.2%
Reported Fellowship of at least 100 believers	5,620 million	93.7%
World Totals	6,000 million	100.0%

Key Observation: The Joshua Project list represents about 2.3 billion individuals living in about 1600 people groups that are less than 2% Evangelical and less than 5% Adherents.

Joshua Project – Least Reached Peoples Only

Church Planting Progress: % of People Groups	1990	Oct 1997	Oct 2000
Targeted for Church Planting by mid-2002	66%	77%	100%
Targeted for Church Planting by Dec 31, 2000	66%	77%	85%
Church Planting Team currently on-site	39%	43%	68%
Reported Fellowship of at least 100 Indigenous believers	Not available	4%	31%

Key Observation: Almost 70% of the people groups on the Joshua Project list of least reached peoples do not have a reported fellowship of at least 100 indigenous believers.

"Church for Every People" Summary:

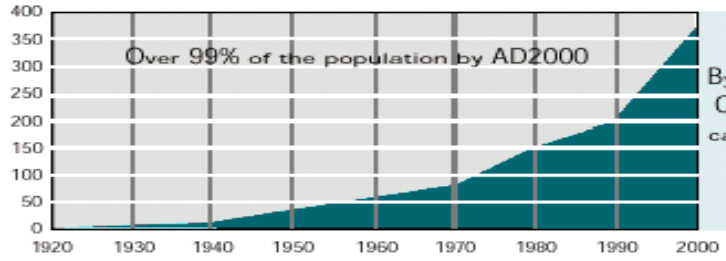
By December 31, 2000, nearly 99% of the world's population will live in a people group that has an actual or planned on-site church planting team.

Figure 5

The Gospel for Every Person

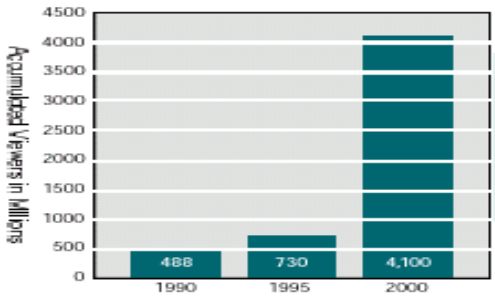
"Go into all the world and preach the gospel to all creation" Mark 16:15

Mega-Languages with Christian Radio Broadcasting



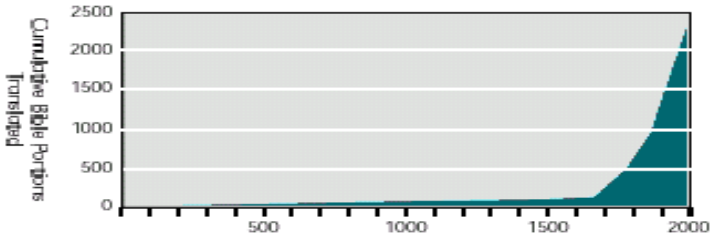
Key Observation:
By December 31, 2000, Christian radio broadcasts will cover an estimated 99% of the world's population.

Jesus Film Estimated Viewers

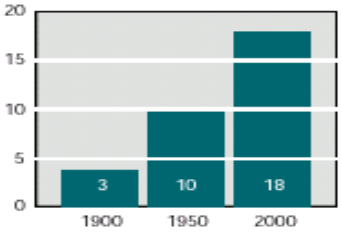


Key Observation:
By December 31, 2000, there will been over 4.1 billion viewers of the Jesus Film and it will be available in languages known by 99% of the world's population.

Bible Translation Status



Annual Rate of Portions Translated



Key Observation:
By December 31, 2000, 8 out of every 10 people will have access to the entire Bible in their own language. 94 out of 100 will have access to the New Testament.a

"Gospel for Every Person" Summary:

By December 31, 2000, between 75-85% of the population of the world will have heard the gospel.

The Charismatic/Post-Denominational/Apostolic Reformation Churches Wave

Research shows continuities but also new innovations and expressions of impulses in moves of God through His people. Closely associated with and flow out of the Pentecostal and Charismatic movements emerged a powerful new expression of these impulses. Building on what has happened up until the 1970's, this tended to be influenced by D.L. Moody. In the late 80's, this became more Charismatically oriented and the last twenty years saw a global movement toward the Holy Spirit (Shenk 2001). The AD2000 Movement was caught up in this wave with approximately half of the active participants, while at the same time its coalition still included in the other half, with some of the historic mainline denominations, independent churches and other mission movements and agencies.

In the last twenty five years of the century a reshaping of the church has begun to take place with new vision, empowered and vitalized to launch a new global thrust in mission. Drawing from the spiritual stream of the Charismatic movement, in which there are notable comparisons to the Puritan spiritual renewal movement, in the following characteristics: 1). sensitivity to the Holy Spirit, 2). pervades all structural forms of the Church without becoming a separate denominational stream, 3). results in a powerful new missionary impulse.

> Restorational movements since AD1500 have accelerated in their frequency of occurrence from three hundred years apart to one hundred to fifty to every ten years during the last half of the 20th century. Each prepared the way for the next over the past 500 years. The Protestant Movement prepared the way for the Holiness Movement and so on, the Pentecostal for the Latter Rain Restoration for the Charismatic Renewal and Faith Movement for the present Prophetic Movement, which is now preparing the way for the Apostolic Movement… (Hamon 1997:19).

With an emphasis on the restoration of the five-fold gifting of the Holy Spirit of apostle, prophet, evangelist, pastor and teacher from Ephesians 4:11, a growing Charismatic stream emerges out of the Pentecostal movement emphasizing the charismata (gifts) trace their beginnings to the 1950's.

> The Holy Spirit is presently taking the Church through a process of transition, preparation and progression toward the Apostolic Movement and final restorational moves of God.. A restoration movement is when God sovereignly chooses to restore certain major truths, ministries and spiritual experiences that have not been active since the early years of the Church (Hamon 1997:9).

Early conceptualizers of the reshaping church movement in the last decade include Bill Hamon and C. Peter Wagner. Elmer Towns also comments about this new expression of church.

> Today, I see new churches sprouting that have adopted new names, new methods and new worship expressions. I see a new alliance of churches, but these new alliances are not called denominations. Yet they have some of the same features that originally attracted old churches into the old denominations. The glue that binds these new denominations together is the Great Commission…(Wagner 1998:8)

Summarizing the sequential timeline of the emergence of the churches embracing a sense of the restoration of the five-fold gifting of Ephesians 4:11, a strategist writes:

> We experienced the restoration of the power ministries of healing, miracles, and deliverance. These signs and wonders fueled an evangelistic thrust in the late 50s and on into the 60s. The pastoral ministry came to center stage in the 1960's to service this growing body of believers. The "Jesus" movement in the late 60s spun off and established many new churches and parachurch ministries. The discipleship and shepherding movements also flowed out of this pastoral anointing. The 1970's was the decade of the teacher. The word and faith movements were both born during this time along with the restoration of the gifts of wisdom, faith, tongues and interpretation of tongues (McCausland 2000).

Wagner suggests, that though not in the five-fold list in Ephesians 4:11, the gift of intercessor emerged in the 1980's as catalytic gift. "One of the most significant developments connected to the prayer movement has been the emergence of the office of intercessor…" In the same decade he observed the emergence of the office of prophet as a "governmental" gifting which in his view is foundation for the new century.

> A generation of two ago, certain segments of the Body of Christ began to recognize the office of prophet in their midst… It was only in the 1980's that prophets began to be accepted by a wider spectrum of the Church (Wagner 2000:18-19).

Regarding the gift of apostle, Wagner acknowledges that the Roman Catholic, Anglican and Episcopalian churches and other denominations have "apostolic" in their name, yet suggests that the emphases of those movements had not penetrated "the

mainstream of what I am calling life-giving evangelical churches that now are the cutting edge of the spread of Christianity. This only began to happen in the 1990's" (Wagner 2000:21).

What about a name for this group of churches? While the new movement was once called "Postdenominational Churches," the term was change to The New Apostolic Reformation churches as a more appropriate expression of their nature (Wagner 1998:9). Some of the leaders are using the denominational nomenclature. "New Life launched an apostolic network, which I think will evolve into a denomination, called the Association of Life-Giving Churches (ALC)" (Haggard 2001).

In the present church-reshaping around the concept of the restoration of the five-fold ministries listed in Ephesians 4:11, a conscious connection has been made between renewal to the restoration of truths, ministries and spiritual experiences and then to mission. Christian leaders and churches identified with this movement around the world tend to have mission engagement both locally and globally on a large scale as does the Faith Community Church in Singapore, and Deeper Life Church in Nigeria (Wagner 1998:213-255).

A number of ministers of large churches around the world view themselves has an integral part of these fresh streams as recorded in Wagner's *The New Apostolic Churches* (1998). While some Christian leaders and churches are going through restoration of

giftings and dramatic change independently, there are efforts underway to move from an interdependent functioning organism of like-minded churches to a larger scale synergistic society.

Revivalism and Mission as Social Reform

Throughout church history renewal has led to greater social concern and social transformation. In his book demonstrating the relationship between revivalism and social reform, particularly as it related to the issue of slavery on the eve of the Civil War in the U.S. the author concludes: "…the churches were making a far greater impact upon American society than their numbers or separation from the state would imply" (Smith 1957, 1980:44). When the winner of the 1993 Nobel Prize in economics published a book titled *The Fourth Great Awakening and the Future of Egalitarianism* in May 2000, there was recognition of the impact it would have immediately as noted by the book review in the New York Times. "When a man of Jewish descent and probably an atheist and an economist to boot starts speaking of a maldistribution of spiritual goods and praises Christian churches for their good works, we should pay great attention to his arguments" (New York Times 2000). According to Fogel, the United States is in the midst of a consistent cycle of economic, religious, and political movements that have

occurred throughout the history of the United States, named “Great Awakenings” by historians.

> The First Great Awakening, which began in 1730, laid the ideological foundation for the American Revolution. The second, starting in 1800, introduced many daring reforms, including the abolition of slavery. The Third Great Awakening, from 1890 to 1930, emphasized social injustice and launched the welfare state. America's new awakening, which began in the late 1950’s, promotes a zealous new movement focused on spiritual rather than material reforms (Fogel 2000:10).

In essence Fogel confirms the thesis of this paper that authentic renewal inherently leads to mission and social reform. He looks to the nation's past to discover the strong link between cycles of awakenings in American history and attitudes towards poverty, education and social equality. Specifically, he attributes the evangelical awakenings to the evangelical Protestant churches.

Fogel traces the social impact of each of the four awakenings and argues for the long-term impact of the evangelical churches over and above what he calls “the radical wing of the modernist camp” that emerged from the Third Great Awakening which came to be called, the Social Gospel movement (Fogel 2000:14).

He documents the positive social impact over the hundred years until 2000.

- The homeless rates in the U.S. from the 1830s to the 1850s reached between 10 and 20% of the population. Today, the homeless rate in the United States is under 0.4%.

- Women's wages have, on average, risen 50% more rapidly than those of men over the past nine decades. From 1940 to 1980, the wages of black males relative to those of white males nearly doubled, raising from a ratio of 43% to 74%.

- In 1880, the typical worker averaged about 3100 hours of labor a year. Today, the "workyear" has decreased to about 1730 hours.

The fourth awakening supports what he calls “spiritual” or “immaterial” reforms.

Over the course of the book, Fogel names “spiritual” assets such as:

- a sense of purpose;
- a work ethic, including a “sense of discipline” and a “capacity to resist the lure of hedonism”;
- a “sense of the mainstream of work and life, a sense of where opportunities are and how to pursue them”;
- a “strong family ethic,” including a “palpable commitment . . . to love [one’s] children unequivocally”;
- a “capacity for self-education” coupled with a “thirst for knowledge”; and,
- a “self-esteem,” defined as a “belief in one’s capacity to succeed in an undertaking.”

Likewise in Latin America, British Socialist David Martin, from the London School of Economics writes a scholarly analysis of the positive sociological impact of the explosive evangelical awakening during the twentieth century. He presents case studies from throughout Latin America of the role, especially of the Pentecostals, in fostering societal change in the twentieth century (Martin 1900).

Throughout church history, the pendulum has swung back and forth in terms of emphasis of mission with regard to social action. This has been a major missiological discussion among Protestant Christians over the last fifty years of the century.

Influenced by the Edinburgh 1910 Mission Conference, the Life and Work Movement was concerned with Christian social witness and Christian ethics, the Faith and Order Movement was concerned with theology, doctrines of the church, its ministry and sacraments proposed the formation a World Council of Churches in 1948. The concept of many of the founders was unity for the sake of mission. In 1961, the International Missionary Council (IMC) merged with the World Council of Churches (WCC) and this became the Commission of World Mission and Evangelism (CWME). However, churches associated with the WCC have seen a great decline in their involvement in cross-cultural mission. For both theological and structural reasons the associated historic denominational churches have suffered great decline and the World Council of Churches has become largely irrelevant to the world mission movement. British sociologist David Martin observes that over the past thirty or so years the religious map of the world has changed dramatically. The World Council of Churches' share of the Protestant constituency has shrunk by an estimated quarter of a billion people (Martin 1995:26).

A new evangelical ecumenism began with the Lausanne Movement which was launched at a conference in Lausanne in 1974 (Lausanne I). As the primary architect of the influential Lausanne Covenant and spokesman for Lausanne, John Stott crafted perspective on mission that included both evangelism and social action:

> "Mission" is the loving service which God sends his people into the world to render. It includes both evangelism and social action, for each is in itself an authentic expression of love and neither needs the other to justify it. Yet because of the appalling lostness of man there is an insistent urgency about our evangelistic task (Stott 1975:108).

The matter of emphasis on the social cultural mandate in mission continued to be a point of tension as observed in these comments by David Bosch in relation to the Pattaya 1980 Lausanne (LCWE) conference, at which several hundred delegates sided with a "Statement of Concern on the future of the LCWE," in which the LCWE leadership was criticized in no uncertain terms for the way in which it had emphasized the evangelistic mandate to the almost total, exclusion of the church's calling in the area of justice and peace (Bosch 1991:406).

In a joint conference of LCWE and WEF, Bosch and other advocates for a more holistic approach to mission gathered at Wheaton '83. Orlando Costas, a prominent Latin American theologian in his presentation appealed for a more holistic strategy.

> The complexity of our world, the comprehensive character of the Christian world mission and the diversities of Third World mission, point to the need for a holistic strategy. That is, one that is comprehensive

> enough to allow for the multiple gifts of ministry, the multidimensional nature of the gospel… (Costas 1983:226).

The Two-Thirds World Church Emerges as a Full Partner in Mission

In the most recent decade, birthed out of the spiritual harvest in Asia, Africa and Latin America, a global evangelical coalition resulted in the expansion of the Christian movement into most of the largest linguistically distinct peoples throughout the earth. From a regional Church based almost exclusively in Western Europe and the U.S., in the year 1900, noted the last fifty years of the century saw the transformation of the Church to a global Church. In 1942 Temple said: "The great new fact of our time is the Church in every country of the world." By 1973 Ralph Winter was saying "The Emergence of the Two-Third World Mission force is the Great new fact of our time." The last twenty five years saw the internationalization of world missions. Churches in Asia, Africa and Latin were sending out tens of thousands of missionaries by the end of the year 2000. The locus of Christian initiative shifted from North to South and West to East.

Lausanne I in 1974 set the stage for hearing the voice of the two-thirds world Church, providing a new platform for non-Western Christian leaders. "Recent surveys of mission theology reveal the continued domination of Western voices, coupled with no discernible shift during the 1990's" (Kirk 2000).

> In light of the fact that the Christian majority is now to be found outside the West and missionary initiatives from the churches of Asia, Africa, and Latin America are at the cutting-edge of the Christian world mission, we must ask: What kind of theology of mission will best serve the global Christian mission in the future? What fresh theological resources can be brought to bear on this new phase of the Christian mission? It is time to listen to voices from the non-Western world that can help construct a theology capable of empowering the global church for participation in the *Missio Dei* (Shenk 2001).

Since, as Shenk puts it: "Vital theology of mission flows from missionary engagement," there is a need to hear what God is saying through His servants in Africa, Asia and Latin America today.

Global mission initiative has been taken up by the two-thirds world in the last decade through the AD2000 Movement. In the lead article of Mission Frontiers titled "The Third World takes the Lead," the Managing Editor writes: "The AD2000 And Beyond Movement, led by third world leaders… is raising up international leadership from dozens of countries" (Wood 1992:6-8).

The challenge in the twenty-first century is enabling creative partnership to share resources between the majority world with its fresh initiative of mission and the experience and knowledge of the west.

V. THE PRACTICAL IMPLICATIONS

Several practical implications emerge for Christians in the twenty-first century out of the demonstrated inherent linkage between authentic spiritual renewal and the expansion of the Christian movement.

First, this is a wake-up call. Awareness of God at work in movements of renewal throughout the world at the end of the twentieth century create a God-given expectation for a macro mission advance which could be released by an act of faith and obedience to step forward in mission in word and deed. As Paul wrote:

> And do this, understanding the present time. The hour has come for you to wake up from your slumber, because our salvation is nearer now than when we first believed. The night is nearly over; the day is almost here. So let us put aside the deeds of darkness and put on the armor of light. (Rom. 13:11-12)

Second, a genuine test of renewal asks the question: does it align the recipients with God's agenda rather than the world's agenda? Ultimately the appropriate question becomes: are we as the body of Christ in our city, nation or world cooperating with what the Holy Spirit is doing in our twenty-first century context of globalization?

Third, this is a call to a life of abandonment and devotion to God. Drive deeper in pursuit of a more authentic Christian life both individually, as a family and in small groups of other believers. Recognizing that, as men and woman go deeper in their life with God, renewal takes place launching a micro mission impulse which under the purpose and will of God through multiplied others can become a macro pulsation.

Fourth, read and study the Bible books about our union with Christ, such as *Hudson Taylor's Spiritual Secret*. Recognize the value yet limitation of some of the writings by Watchman Nee and some of the components of the Keswick stream that focus on spiritual development without responsible engagement in culture (Lovelace 1979:17).

Fifth, do not judge new movements too quickly. Take a posture as did Gamaliel when he spoke to the secular leaders of his day concerning the new Spiritual movement of Christians.

> … Gamaliel, a teacher of the law, who was honored by all the people, stood up in the Sanhedrin and ordered that the men be put outside for a little while. Then he addressed them: 'Men of Israel, consider carefully what you intend to do to these men… Leave these men alone! Let them go! For if their purpose or activity is of human origin, it will fail. But if it is from God, you will not be able to stop these men; you will only find yourselves fighting against God." (Acts 5:34-35, 38b-39).

Sixth, view each crisis as an opportunity. As the Chinese written expression for crisis includes two figures, one designating risk and the other opportunity, so every crisis

is an opportunity for a new surge in religious interest and corresponding mission initiative. "… early Christians experienced a substantial repetition of the pattern of crisis/prayer/empowerment, documented in Acts 4:23-37" (Lovelace 1979:49).

Seventh, after reviewing the options and considering your own spiritual passions, get involved in a practical mission. Become a steward of the resources of God for the cause of mission. Mobilize others for missions.

Eighth, incorporate into the vocabulary of God's people terminology to enlighten and motivate for mission the following fresh expressions with accompanying provisional definitions.

- A micro surge is a step of obedient faith in which a Christian engages in mission to the glory of God.
- A macro surge occurs when a group of God's people agree together and engage in mission with a common vision to the glory of God that makes a major long-term impact on the community in which they live.
- A meta surge takes place when the course of human history is dramatically changed through the mission initiative of God's people.
- A micro impulse involves the touch of the Holy Spirit reviving the inner person in such a way that the person knows with assurance that he/she is accepted in Jesus, free from the bondage of sin, indwelt by the Holy Spirit; with authority in Christ to engage in spiritual conflict.
- A macro impulse occurs when a micro impulse takes place in enough of God's people so as to result in the awakening of special concern in church members and extending the influence of the Kingdom of God in a major fashion in the local community and across social, and/or racial, and/or linguistic and and/or geographic barriers to the glory of God.

- A meta revival occurs when a macro impulse happens in such a magnitude so as leave a major impact on history.

Ninth, develop a series of illustrations and case studies to buttress the fresh expressions for motivating renewal and mission. For example, what would constitute a meta surge? Perhaps in church history, you could say unequivocally that the first 303 years of Christianity constituted a meta-surge; whether you extend that to the first 450 years requires further reflection.

CONCLUSION

As we look back at 2000 years of mission, we can see throughout that there exists an the inherent linkage between renewal and fresh mission initiatives. In establishing this paradigm of mission I have develop a theoretical framework, looked at the biblical and theological basis from Pentecost in Acts chapter two, examined the historical evidence from Pentecost to 1950, considered four major developments from 1950 to 2000 and suggested some practical implications.

In considering the many issues that have different contexts, several questions remain in seeking to advance the Christian movement in the twenty first century to the glory of God.

- How can the global Christian movement be encouraged to launch a fresh wave of mission out of the major global evangelical awakening of the past fifty years?
- How can the people of God be encouraged to discover and define new frontiers for the sake of the Gospel without neglecting the need for nurture within the Church?
- How can the global missionary movement discover and then move across the remaining cultural, racial, social, and geographic barriers?
- How are leaders to be selected, trained and encouraged to finish well to lead the twenty first century movement?
- How can the whole church be encouraged and mobilized in mission?
- How can the body of Christ build and maintain the existing effective structures, while at the same time encouraging the creativity of the Holy Spirit through men and women on the periphery in the reshaping of the church for mission—both local and global?
- How can we further understand the relationship between the Gospel and culture in which to engage in mission in a pluralistic and postmodern world?

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